

Big Picture in Focus: *ULO*b. explain the language planning processes

Metalanguage

For you to demonstrate this ULO, you will need to have an operational understanding of the following terms below. Please note that you will also be required to refer to the previous definitions found in the previous sections.

- a. **Status Planning-** aspects of language planning which reflect primarily social issues and concerns and hence are external to the language(s) being planned.
- b. **Corpus Planning-** aspects of language planning which are primarily linguistic and hence internal to language.

Essential Knowledge

To perform the aforesaid big picture (unit learning outcomes) for the first three (3) weeks of the course, you need to fully understand the following essential knowledge that will be laid down in the succeeding pages. Please note that you are not limited to exclusively refer to these resources. Thus, you are expected to utilize other books, research articles and other resources that are available in the university's library e.g. *ebrary, search.proquest.com etc.*

LANGUAGE PLANNING PROCESS

Stages of the Language Planning Process

CC's Voice: This section is intended for the discussion of the arguably most cited model of language planning. Haugen's Model (1983) is discussed thoroughly by Kaplan and Baldauf (1997). Hence, their work is used in this section. We will begin by reading the status planning and the processes under it, and eventually corpus planning and the processes under it. All of which constitute the mentioned model.

Language Planning as a Process

- Three complementary frameworks are initially examined, those proposed by Haugen (1983), Haarmann (1990) and Cooper (1989) along with some other critical variables necessary to provide an overall framework for understanding language policy and planning.
- First we turn to a structural framework for language planning which looks at the various stages and activities which can be said to occur as part of the planning process. Researchers in language planning have attempted to differentiate two distinct kinds of activities—those that are concerned specifically with attempts to modify language itself, and those that are concerned with attempts to modify the environment in which a language is used. These have come to be designated

'corpus planning' and 'status planning', respectively. Such a separation constitutes something of an oversimplification; it is, in fact, virtually impossible, in practice, to separate the two activities. The fact is that any change in the character of a language is likely to result in a change in the use environment, and any change in the use environment is likely to induce a change in the character of the language.

Haugen's (1983) Revised Language Planning Model

	Form (policy planning)	Function (language cultivation)
Status Planning (Society)	Selection (decision procedures)	Implementation (educational spread)
Corpus Planning (Language)	Codification (graphization, grammatication, lexication)	Elaboration (functional development)

- **Status Planning**

- The two status issues which make up the model are language selection and language implementation.

- **Language Selection**

- Selection of a language(s) focuses on the development of language policy. Selection involves the choice of a language(s) by/for a society through its political leaders. Such decisions are usually made from among competing languages and or dialects. The language or language items selected establish the particular linguistic form which is to be the norm and which is to have status within society.
- **Identification of problem-** The choice of a national language(s) is not as simple as it seems on the surface since such selection normally implies a choice among competing languages. Vernacular languages provide the opportunity to establish a common heritage, a common history, and to facilitate unity; on the other hand, exogenous languages often provide access to the external world. The choice of a language(s) ideally should result in the smallest

possible disruption to the social structure, yet at the same time the decision should not isolate the polity from the outside world.

- Various criteria for selecting a language have been proposed and include such things as **political neutrality, dominance, prestige, a great tradition and areal affinity** (Kale, 1990: 185-6). However, one must be aware that such criteria are themselves value laden, and cannot all be weighted equally.
- Politics of necessity then must choose among the available alternatives. The choice is not always an easy one. The former colonial language, spoken by an elite and probably providing access to the larger modern world, may not be a good choice if an objective of the choice is to facilitate national unity, since the colonial language may be regarded as a symbol of oppression by some segments of the population, but also may not be spoken by any significant segment of the population. If not a foreign language, then which of the indigenous languages? The criteria of dominance—that is, a language spoken by a clear numerical majority—may be chosen, provided that the choice is not opposed by other significant segments of the population. Other types of dominance include: the language of the capital city, the language of the wealthiest group, the language of the most powerful group, or the language of the political elite.
- While the choice of a language constitutes a difficult problem, polities do, at some point, make a choice. Once a choice has been made, there are a number of other problems to be dealt with. **If the choice falls on a foreign language**, that language is likely already to have a standard form, and a set of dictionaries, grammars, etc., are likely to exist. But it is often the case that the **variety of the colonial language** most widely spoken in the new polity is not the same variety that is spoken in the former colonial power. In such cases, there is the problem of which variety to accept. **The metropolitan variety** has a number of advantages, but it may not be spoken by many people; the local variety may be spoken by many people but may to some extent preclude the wider communication for which it was chosen in the first place. **The choice of a local language** also raises the question of variety. Modern English and French are the varieties which were dominant around London and Paris about 500 years ago and which have now become accepted as national languages.

- **Allocation of norms-** Allocation of norms is no less complex than the initial identification of the language to be selected. If one can assume that the choice of a language for a specific purpose (i.e. a national language, a foreign language, a regional variety, etc.) has already been accomplished, the next series of problems deals with the establishment of norms. Let us say that English has been chosen as one of the national languages; the question then becomes 'which English?'.
 - On the other hand, if a local vernacular is chosen, that vernacular may not be standardized. Decisions must be made regarding the variety of the local vernacular that will be 'officialized'. It is further possible that the local vernacular will not have a standardized lexicon and/or a standardized grammar. Indeed, it is possible that the local variety may not have a standardized orthography. It is also possible that the lexicon of the local vernacular may not be particularly well suited to the needs of a modernizing society; new lexical items may need to be created to facilitate the language's ability to deal with modern concepts, particularly in education. For example, in the Philippines, Pilipino (since 1987 known as Filipino) a 'nationalized' form of Tagalog—is mandated throughout the educational system, except in the teaching of science and mathematics where English remains the language of instruction, largely as an outcome of the relative lack of technical terminology in Pilipino.
- **Language Implementation**
 - Having taken the decision about what language(s) and what variety(ies) or norms are to be adopted, these policies need to be put in place. The implementation of a language plan focuses on the adoption and spread of the language form that has been selected and codified. This is often done through the educational system and through other laws or regulations which encourage and/or require the use of the standard and perhaps discourage the use of other languages or dialects. While education was the preserve of the few, it was relatively easy to spread the standard. However, the coming of mass education has made language implementation a major issue. Very few nation-states are linguistically homogeneous, and the choice of any standard will certainly disadvantage some members of that heterogeneous community.
 - 'Correction' is the term used by language planners to describe the specific measures taken to implement the social aspects of a

language plan. Strategies need to be devised to promote language spread and to prevent the development of a linguistic underclass which has no access to the language change. While the formal educational system often plays a major role in the implementation of correction procedures, it is clear that the education sector alone is not capable of providing for language correction, partly because dissemination through the education system requires several generations, and partly because the education sector lacks the authority to impact on other segments of society.

- Some of the complex range of concerns of the Ministry of Education are that the education sector has to disseminate and store the teaching materials prepared—dictionaries, grammar books, etc.; it has to decide what segment of the school day will be allocated to language education at what levels of the educational structure. It has to decide what the objectives of instruction are at each level. It has to decide what other segment of the population will provide the teachers, what training the teachers shall receive over what period of time. It has to decide how to induce students

- **Corpus Planning**

- Haugen divides processes in corpus planning into two categories: those related to the establishment of norms, and those related to the extension of the linguistic functions of language. In his model Haugen labels the former category **'Codification'** (or standardization) procedures, and the latter, **'Elaboration'** (or the functional development of language).
- **Codification**
 - Codification of a language focuses on the standardization procedures needed to develop and formalize a linguistic and usually literate set of language norms. Codification is usually performed by individuals with linguistic training who decide explicitly the linguistic form the language is to take. For many languages the codification process has become so extensive that language agencies have been created to do the necessary corpus planning work.
 - Haugen (1983) suggests that codification consists of three areas: graphization, grammatication, and lexication.
 - **Graphization-** has been considered the first step in the standardization of a language. Writing systems—whether employing an alphabet, a syllabary or a system of ideograms—provide the basis on which literacy materials can

be established and have the potential to reduce the linguistic variation in a language community (see e.g. Wurm 1994a). A great deal of graphization has been accomplished through the work of the Summer Institute of Linguistics [SIL] (Wycliffe Bible Translators); the SIL has provided orthographies for more previously unwritten languages than any other single source. In the case of a local vernacular which has not developed a standard orthography or which simply does not have a written history, for literacy to occur graphization becomes necessary. It is necessary to devise an orthographic system that reflects the phonology of the language.

- **Grammatication-** involves the extraction and formulation of rules that describe how a language is structured. Most of the grammars developed have been prescriptive and based on the standardized variety of the language, especially those used in schooling or for literacy development.
- **Lexication-** Lexication refers to the selection and development of an appropriate lexicon. As Haugen notes 'in principle this also involves the assignment of styles and spheres of usage for the words of the language' (1983: 271). In its initial stages, lexication may involve specifying how words are used in particular domains.
- The lexicon of a local vernacular, now the national language, will inevitably be rich in resources to deal with all the traditional areas of communication, but it may not be sufficiently rich in the kind of technical terms necessary to permit modernization.

○ **Elaboration**

- Elaboration of a language focuses on the functional development of that language. That is, once a language has been codified there is a need to continue 'the implementation of the norm to meet the functions of a modern world' (Haugen, 1983: 373). Such a modernized language must meet the wide range of cultural demands put upon it in terms of both terminology and style, from those set by the technological, intellectual, and humanistic disciplines to those associated with the everyday and popular aspects of a culture (Haugen, 1983). Haugen has defined elaboration in terms of terminological modernization and stylistic development, but a final and emerging category needs to be added to these established aspects of functional development, that of internationalization.

- **Terminological modernization**, which involves the development of new lexical items or terminology for a language, is undoubtedly one of the areas which has generated the most discussion within corpus planning. In culturally, technologically and economically changing conditions, thousands of new terms must be generated each year in a language if that language is to be fully expressive in every domain.
- **Stylistic development** implies that a language is more than the sum of its lexical, grammatical and syntactic parts (Gee, 1992). Each language has its own discourses appropriate for each of the domains in which it is used. Stylistic development signals a recognition that, without appropriate development of linguistic style in those domains important to a language, it is not fully able to meet all the demands placed upon it.
- **Internationalization** can be seen as a particular type of language spread which affects the corpus of a language. As a language becomes a medium of international communication, rather than just a national or intranational standard, standardization problems arise which parallel each of the categories previously discussed.

Self-Help and References: You can also refer to the sources below to help you further understand the lesson:

Kaplan, R. B., & Baldauf, R. B. (1997). *Language planning from practice to theory* (Vol. 108). Multilingual Matters.

Let's Check

Activity 1. In one paragraph, differentiate status planning and corpus planning.

Let's Analyze

Activity 1. In a 300-word composition, explain the relationship of the language planning process and the goals of language planning.

In a Nutshell

Activity 1. What topic under this section do you think would help you in your teaching of the English language? Why?

Keywords Index

paralinguistic stages	protowords	holophrastic stage
telegraphic stage	acquisition of negation	acquisition of questions
	grammatical morphemes	